

N • E • W • S • P • R • I • N • T

sufficiently minority-interest in its readership for me to feel no shame in drawing your attention to the edition (Feb 27) as an excellent primer on the American software business.

Facts and figures (*BW* can dig these out of a report on the hum of a bumble-bee) showing how software is booming, were fascinating. For instance, the amount of money spent on personal computers will be about a third of the total computer budget, by 1989. But on software, personal software will only account for roughly a fifth.

The interesting thing was the suggestion, just before an analysis of the Japanese future, that money is available, at last, for software start-ups.

Ovation raised \$5 million on the venture market last year, and *BW* quoted Thomas Gregory, president, saying that the hardware side had frightened so many capitalists, they had turned to software. What really tickled me, however, was the suggestion that 'the best time is over' already.

Over already? Software hasn't even started, and the money men are ready to get cold feet *already*.

I'm afraid, however, it is so. A few 'stars' will be able to raise money. But innovators, for the next couple of years, are going to live in the shadow of financiers' ignorance, and the general belief that the IBM micro is an advanced machine. The market is getting hopelessly stagnant,

both hard and software.

Guy Kewney

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Australian Knight

SME Systems has announced a \$3,300 business micro running CP/M 3.0. The Knight 2000 uses a Z80 processor with 256k of RAM. On line storage is provided by two 780k floppy disk drives with the option of upgrading to a 20 Mb hard disk.

Voice synthesis and graphics are also provided. Details on (03) 874 3666.

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Paying for the privilege

Wonderful though electronic mail is, I suspect Hawkeye Graphix is onto a winner. The company is offering software to let you establish your own electronic link with your office rather than

having to work through some outside corporation.

The company has considerable experience with comms software and so I do expect its 'private electronic mail system' to work.

Electronic Mail Manager is described as 'a powerful method of coordinating communications between several offices in a business'.

In other words, just because you are out of your office, it doesn't mean you can't reach your micro. With a portable micro, or borrowing the micro of the person whose office you are visiting, you dial into your own computer, and run it.

The catch is the price. You need the Comms package at \$150 per micro, and you then have to buy EMM (written in dBasell) at \$150 for the run-time module, then a master-slave pair program at \$400, with \$100 extra for each additional slave branch...

Details on (213) 373 9627 at Torrance, California.

Guy Kewney

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The Australian Knight 2000 personal computer